Fight for Manhood

Week 3 Group Leader Guide

FATHER FIGURES — From Wounded Son to Healed Son

Leader emphasis: This week is not about bashing fathers. It is about understanding how men were shaped, moving from a wounded son mindset to a healed son mindset, and helping men take one concrete step toward clarity, reconciliation, and sonship.

1. The Point of the Night

- Men carry a deep father-longing. When that longing goes unmet, it affects identity, relationships, and how a man sees God.
- The goal is not to leave men stuck in blame, but to move them toward understanding, healing, and restoration.
- The presentation presses one practical pathway to manhood: if a father is still alive, pursue understanding through conversation.
- The deeper shift is this: from 'my dad did me wrong' to 'my dad was also a wounded son' — and from there to receiving God as Father.

2. Leader Posture and Tone

- Be calm, direct, and compassionate.
- **Do not let the group turn into a father-bashing session.**
- Let men be honest, but keep gently moving them from accusation to understanding.
- Do not force vulnerability. Invite honesty, but do not make men perform openness.
- Keep the group practical. Tonight should end with a clear step, not just emotion.

3. Simple Flow for the Breakout

2–3 min	Welcome the men in, settle the room, and remind them this week is about understanding, not blaming.
3–5 min	Re-state the big idea: a son's longing for his father was never wrong, and healing starts by bringing that longing into the light.
30–45 min	Work through the discussion questions below. Use the set that fits each man's situation.
5–8 min	Push the assignment. Make sure each man leaves with one specific next step.
2–3 min	Close in prayer: clarity, courage, healing, and restored sonship.

4. Discussion Questions

Use whichever set fits the man in front of you.

A. If his father is still alive

Question: If you could ask your dad one question that would help you understand him and yourself better, what would it be?

Follow-up / assignment: Ask him that question this week, or set a specific time and place to ask it.

Leader prompts: Help him make the question concrete and honest. Push him toward one real question, not five vague ones.

B. If his father is gone or dead

Question: If your dad were sitting in front of you right now, what one question would you ask that would help you understand what shaped him — and what shaped you?

Follow-up / assignment: Write that question down. Then either ask it to someone who knew him well, or bring that question before God and ask Him to show you what shaped your father, what shaped you, and what He wants to heal now.

Leader prompts: Do not let this become sentimental only. Keep moving toward understanding, not just loss.

C. For fathers in the room

Question: What is the one thing you know you need to clearly communicate to your son or sons that you have not said yet?

Follow-up / assignment: Go say it this week.

Leader prompts: If needed, press them toward clarity: identity, love, pride, blessing, apology, or calling.

D. For everyone

Question: Do you believe God when He says He is your Father — your real Dad? If so, how does that change the way you see Him now, and the way you think He sees you?

Follow-up / assignment: Write down one sentence that names how your view of God as Father needs to change this week.

Leader prompts: This question matters because many men still approach God through the lens of father-wound and performance religion.

5. Helpful Follow-Ups

- ***How has that shaped the way you relate to God now?***
- ***If God really is your Father, what lie about yourself starts to lose power?***

- What question have you carried for years but never asked?
- What would it cost you emotionally to ask it now?
- What do you think you have assumed about your father without ever confirming it?
- What did you most want from your father?

6. Things to Watch For in the Group

- Some men will move quickly to anger. Let them be honest, but guide them toward understanding.
- Some men will shut down and say, 'It doesn't matter anymore.' That often means it matters deeply.
- Some men may feel grief if their father is gone. Do not rush them, but do not leave them there without direction.
- If a man shares something heavy, thank him for being honest and keep the room steady. No fixing, no preaching at him, no one-upping his story.
- The win tonight is not emotional intensity. The win is clarity plus a concrete next step.

7. Suggested Closing

You can say something like:

> "This week is not about staying stuck in what was missing. It is about bringing that father-longing into the light. If your dad is still alive, move toward understanding. If he is gone, still move toward understanding. And in all of it, do not forget the deeper truth: God is not like your father. He is your Father. Let's take one real step this week."

8. Prayer Focus

- Ask God for courage to move toward truth instead of avoidance.
- Ask God to expose lies men have believed about themselves because of father wounds.
- Ask God to begin turning hearts of fathers to children and children to fathers.
- Ask God to father men in the exact places where they were wounded.

9. Leader Reminder

A healed son is far more capable of becoming a present father.